Support libraries for Bluetooth, EDGE, 3G, and Wi-Fi. Given, the hardware is found, these libraries will help in implementation and construction of device drivers.

Camera, GPS, compass, and accelerometer

Support libraries for Camera, GPS, compass and accelerometer. Given, the hardware is found, these libraries will help in implementation and construction of device drivers.

Messaging libraries

Support libraries for SMS and MMS messaging. Also include support from threaded text messaging. Number of messages stored in memory is only limited by memory.

Default Homescreen of iPhone 3GS running OS 3.0

Security and permissions

Android is a multi-process system, in which each application (and parts of the system) runs in its own process. Most security between applications and the system is enforced at the process level through standard Linux facilities, such as user and group IDs that are assigned to applications. Additional finer-grained security features are provided through a "permission" mechanism that enforces restrictions on the specific operations that a particular process can perform, and per-URI permissions for granting ad-hoc access to specific pieces of data.

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A central design point of the Android security architecture is that no application, by default, has permission to perform any operations that would adversely impact other applications, the operating system, or the user. This includes reading or writing the user's private data such as contacts or emails, reading or writing another application's files, performing network access and keeping the device awake.

An application's process is a secure sandbox. It can't disrupt other